

THE MOVE

Hear the detail -> infer the possible significance -> phrase it tentatively -> invite correction -> pause. -> It sounds like that mattered because it changed what you could count on. -> It seems bigger than the event itself — maybe what it said ab...

START HERE

It sounds like that mattered because it changed what you could count on.

SAY THIS

Quick starters	<i>"It sounds like that mattered."</i>
Validating the signifi...	<i>"It sounds like that wasn't just inconvenient — it changed what felt reliable."</i>
At work & in meetings	<i>"It sounds like the concern isn't the timeline — it's whether the team felt consulted."</i>
Name it, invite correc...	<i>"It sounds like the significance was being trusted — tell me if I've got that wrong."</i>
Repair & softening	<i>"It was not only the outcome; it was what the outcome seemed to say."</i>
Under pressure & hig...	<i>"I might have this wrong, but it sounds like the real worry is whether it happens again."</i>

AVOID

- When the person only wants practical information.
- When naming meaning would feel invasive or theatrical.
- When you are guessing from too little evidence.

REMEMBER

Offer meaning as a hypothesis, not a verdict.